

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #008 — Film Development Template
CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf
Tolerance: 0%

1. The Decision

EVERY FILM MUST INCLUDE ALL REQUIRED FIELDS

No film is approved until every field below is filled in.

The first film has one extra field.

2. Required Fields

#	Field	What it must contain
1	Title	The film's official title.
2	What's Being Adapted	The real source material: the events, recordings and memoirs the film is based on, with each primary source named.
3	What the Movie Is About	A one-line summary (logline) plus a full synopsis of the story.
4	Whose Movie / Franchise It Is	The lead character this film, and any franchise that grows from it, belongs to.
5	Antagonist	Who or what the lead is up against.
6	Timeline: When & Where	The start and end dates and the locations. Its place on the TMU master timeline.
7	Standalone World-Building	How the film builds its own world: its characters, settings and story, complete within this film.
8	Motown Universe World-Building	How the film adds to the shared universe through crossover plot elements, settings, cast and characters.
9	Post-Credits Scenes	Whether there are any, how many, and what happens in each.
10	How It Kicks Everything Off (first film only)	How the first film starts the whole Motown Universe: the foundation it lays and the first threads it plants.

3. Field Rules

- **What's Being Adapted.** Only documented history counts as source material. If a scene can't be traced to a source, it's cut or rewritten.
- **Antagonist.** It has to be a real person or a real force: segregation, the industry, a rival, a contract, or personal struggle. No villains are made up. A real person shown as an antagonist is portrayed exactly as the record documents them, with nothing exaggerated and nothing softened.
- **Whose Movie It Is.** The lead gets the film at full documented strength. Crossover characters never take over the lead's story.
- **Timeline.** Dates are fixed points on the master timeline (Memo #005). No film can contradict another film's dates.
- **Motown Universe World-Building.** Every connection must look, from outside, like ordinary historical accuracy. It can't reveal the universe (Memo #007).
- **Post-Credits Scenes.** They must be historically accurate and shot under sealed security (Memo #007). They're a main way the public discovers the universe.
- **How It Kicks Everything Off.** The first film sets up the universe's foundations (the hub, the founder and the house rules) without ever saying out loud that a universe exists.

4. Compliance Check (every film)

Mandate	Requirement	Source
Fidelity	100% historically accurate	Memo #001
No-Nerf	Everyone at full documented strength	Memo #001
Studio	Motown Productions (distributed by Paramount, later Universal)	Memos #002–#003
Phase	Phase 1, 2 or 3, plus its slot in the 23-film plan	Memo #004
Story model	Serialized / standalone share for its phase (40/60, 60/40 or 70/30)	Memo #005
Format	Musical Biographical Drama • PG-13 • 140–165 min (event films up to 180)	Memo #005
Secrecy	Marketed as a standalone biopic, with no universe branding	Memo #007

5. Blank Film Sheet

Copy this sheet for each film.

Field	Entry
Title	
Phase / slot / release year	
What's Being Adapted	
What the Movie Is About	
Whose Movie / Franchise It Is	
Antagonist	
Timeline: When & Where	
Standalone World-Building	
Motown Universe World-Building	
Post-Credits Scenes	
How It Kicks Everything Off (first film only)	
Compliance check passed?	

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios.